



TIPS & TRICKS



How to find the largest files/directories

Here is a tip on how, by using a combination of commands, you can find the five largest files:

```
find . -type f -print0 | xargs -0 du | sort -n | tail -5 |  
cut -f2 | xargs -I{} du -sh {}
```

To find the five largest directories, use the following command:

```
find . -type d -print0 | xargs -0 du | sort -n | tail -5 |  
cut -f2 | xargs -I{} du -sh {}
```

—Gaurav Kumar, gk3eee@gmail.com



Simulating the `wc -l` command using `sed`.

Many tasks can be done with the `sed` command. The following code will simulate the `wc -l` command which counts the number of lines present in the file:

```
[mickey]$ sed -n '$=' file.txt
```

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Before demystifying the above command, let's understand how the `sed` command works. `sed` reads a line from the input file into a pattern buffer (the internal buffer used by `sed`), applies commands (if any) on the pattern buffer and finally prints the modified line on the standard output stream.

Here, the `'='` command prints the line number followed by its contents. `'$ ='` prints the last line number and its contents and the `'-n'` option suppresses the default printing of the pattern buffer. Hence, it displays only the last line number – now, isn't this interesting?

—Narendra Kangralkar,
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Checking a laptop's battery status via the command line

Have you ever tried to check your laptop's battery status from the command line? If not, here's how to go about it.

GNU/Linux provides the `'acpi'` command which can be used to check this.

Execute the following commands to install the `'acpi'` utility in Ubuntu:

```
[bash]$ sudo apt-get update  
[bash]$ sudo apt-get install acpi
```

Now, execute the `'acpi'` command. Shown below is the output when the adapter is not connected to a power source:

```
[bash]$ acpi -b  
Battery 0: Discharging, 96%, 02:41:08 remaining
```

You get the following output when the adapter is connected to a power source:

```
[bash]$ acpi -b  
Battery 0: Charging, 95%, 00:07:37 until charged
```

—Narendra Kangralkar,
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HTTrack: Browse a website without the Internet

This is a GUI based software that downloads the entire website from the Internet for future reading.

For example, if there's a text based tutorial website available to users when the Internet is connected, you can use this software to copy the website once to browse further on your local computer.

To install this software, run the following command:

```
#sudo apt-get install httrack
```

The software will be installed. Now go to the terminal and type the following command:

```
#httrack
```

...and then fill in the project name, website URL